

South’ under the ‘leadership’ of China. Indonesia’s non-aligned stance is at least part of the reason that it turned down the invitation to join the BRICS in 2023.

Capital city: from Jakarta to Nusantara

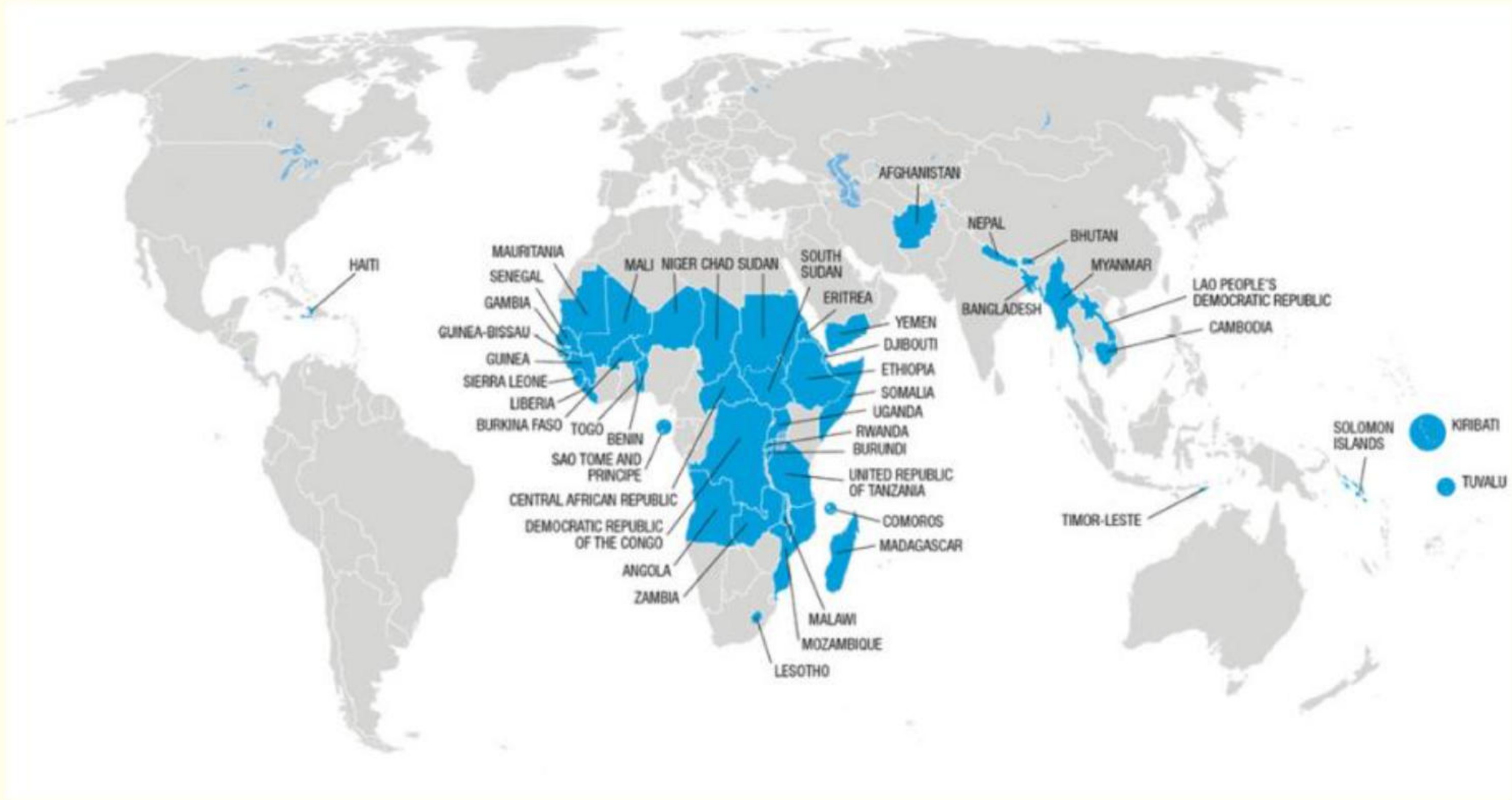
A new capital city called Nusantara (which means *archipelago* in Indonesian) is in the early stages of construction in the heart of the rainforest in Kalimantan (Borneo). This is a US\$45 billion project, announced in 2019, to move the government 1236 km away from the overcrowded and subsiding megacity of Jakarta. Jakarta’s metropolitan area is home to 30 million people. Construction of the new city began in July 2022 in an area of forests and oil palm plantations, 30 km inland from the Makassar Strait. The first stage of development involves constructing government facilities and other buildings for the expected initial population of 500,000. Construction is planned to be completed by 2045.

Activities

- 1 What is Indonesia’s current level of economic development?
- 2 Suggest why Indonesia’s relatively young population structure is viewed as an economic advantage.
- 3 Describe Indonesia’s two waves of structural transformation.
- 4 Why is Indonesia investing heavily in digitisation and sustainable industries?
- 5 Describe and explain the importance for Indonesia of investing in infrastructure.

Practice questions

- 1 [Figure 8.31](#) shows the world’s least-developed countries.
 - a Identify the least developed country in the Americas. [1]
 - b Describe the distribution of the least developed countries. [3]
 - c Suggest why islands such as Kiribati and Tuvalu are among the least developed countries. [3]



▲ **Figure 8.31** The world’s least-developed countries

- 2 [Table 8.11](#) shows life expectancy (years) for selected countries.
 - a Calculate the difference in life expectancy between the country with the highest life expectancy and the country with the lowest life expectancy. [2]
 - b Compare the characteristics of countries with high life expectancy with those with low life expectancy. [4]

▼ **Table 8.11** Life expectancy (years) for selected countries

Highest life expectancy (2020–25)	Lowest life expectancy (2020–25)
Monaco 89.4	Central African Republic 54.4
Hong Kong 85.3	Chad 55.2
Japan 85.0	Lesotho 55.6
Macau 84.7	Nigeria 55.8
Switzerland 84.3	Sierra Leone 55.9

- 3
 - a Identify two economic indicators of development. [2]
 - b Suggest how improving levels of literacy may raise levels of development. [3]
- 4 Using named examples, evaluate ways in which uneven development may be reduced. [7]